EXHAUST—SULFUR ODOR FOLLOWING AGGRESSIVE DRIVING—2.5L VEHICLES—CONTOUR/MYSTIQUE AND COUGAR WITH AUTOMATIC TRANSAXLE—CONTOUR/MYSTIQUE WITH MANUAL TRANSAXLE BUILT FROM 5/7/99—COUGAR WITH MANUAL TRANSAXLE BUILT FROM 5/24/99 ONLY	Article No. 00-25-2

FORD: 1998-2000 CONTOUR

MERCURY: 1998-2000 MYSTIQUE
1999-2000 COUGAR

This TSB is being republished in its entirety to update the vehicle models covered.

ISSUE

An objectionable exhaust, sulfur, or rotten egg odor following aggressive driving, such as full-throttle acceleration, may occur on some vehicles. This may be caused by excessive sulfur in the fuel reacting with the normal chemical reactions which take place in the catalytic converter.

ACTION

Replace the catalytic converter with a revised catalytic converter. Refer to the following Service Procedure for details.

SERVICE PROCEDURE

NOTE

THIS PROCEDURE APPLIES ONLY TO 2.5L CONTOUR/MYSTIQUE AND COUGAR VEHICLES WITH AUTOMATIC TRANSAXLES, 2.5L CONTOUR/MYSTIQUE VEHICLES WITH MANUAL TRANSAXLES (MTX) BUILT FROM 5/7/1999 AND 2.5L COUGAR VEHICLES WITH MANUAL TRANSAXLES (MTX) BUILT FROM 5/24/1999.

1. Follow normal diagnostic routines. If the Malfunction Indicator Lamp (MIL) is illuminated, or if there are any other driveability symptoms present, they must be resolved prior to addressing the exhaust odor concern.
2. Replace the existing catalytic converter with the revised service part. Refer to the 1999 Contour/Mystique or Cougar Workshop Manual, Section 309-00, for the removal and installation procedures. It will also be necessary to replace the five (5) mounting nuts along with the inlet and outlet gaskets as listed in the Parts Block found at the end of this article.

NOTE

SINCE EXHAUST ODOR VARIES WITH THE LEVEL OF SULFUR CONTENT IN THE FUEL, IT MAY ALSO BE APPROPRIATE TO ADVISE THE CUSTOMER TO CHANGE FUEL BRAND (NOT THE OCTANE RATING) TO ACHIEVE MAXIMUM SATISFACTION.

PART NUMBER	PART NAME
YS8Z-5E212-AA	Catalytic Converter
W520103-S309	Nut (5 Required)
XS8Z-9450-AA	Inlet Gasket
F5RZ-5E241-A	Outlet Gasket

OTHER APPLICABLE ARTICLES: NONE
SUPERSEDES: 00-10-7
WARRANTY STATUS: INFORMATION ONLY
OASIS CODES: 403000, 623000

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